

The Dance School Awards: Industry Award - Dance Teacher of the Year:

Dance Teacher of the Year Application / Nomination Questions.

Please find below 5 questions which we will need you to answer to proceed with your nomination.

Judges will consider:

- Quality and clarity of teaching practice
- Ability to motivate, inspire, and support students
- Awareness of different learning needs and pathways
- Commitment to student wellbeing and safe practice
- Evidence of professional integrity and reliability
- Ongoing professional development
- Positive impact within their school or community
- Commitment to inclusive and respectful teaching practice that supports a diverse range of students
- A clear case for why this teacher stands out this year

Email *

k.edkins@hotmail.co.uk

Full Name *

Kathryn Edkins

Email *

k.edkins@hotmail.co.uk

Phone Number *

07815836318

Dance School Name *

All Stars Performing Arts

1. What makes you an exceptional teacher? *

I believe every child deserves to feel seen, valued, and supported. By taking the time to provide individual attention and genuinely getting to know each student, I build meaningful relationships based on trust, kindness, and encouragement.

I care deeply about every student's journey, not only within the studio but beyond it too. I celebrate their successes, support them through challenges, and strive to create a safe, nurturing environment where they feel confident to grow, express themselves, and be exactly who they are.

For me, teaching is about so much more than technique. It's about inspiring confidence, building self-belief, showing compassion, and helping every child flourish both as a performer and as a person.

2. How do you support and inspire your students? *

I believe the best way to inspire young performers is to continually inspire myself. I am committed to developing my own knowledge and skills through ongoing professional training, ensuring my students receive the highest quality teaching and the most up-to-date industry practices.

I regularly invite experienced industry professionals into the studio to deliver workshops and share their expertise, giving students the opportunity to learn from those actively working within the performing arts industry. These experiences broaden their understanding, ignite ambition, and allow them to see the many pathways available to them.

Alongside this, I provide consistent encouragement, guidance, and individual support tailored to each student's needs and aspirations. I celebrate every achievement, no matter how big or small, and create an environment where students feel safe to challenge themselves, learn from mistakes, and grow with confidence.

My aim is not only to develop skilled performers but to inspire resilient, kind, hardworking young people who believe in themselves and have the confidence to pursue their dreams.

3. How do you continue to develop professionally? *

I believe that great teachers never stop learning. I am passionate about continually developing my knowledge and skills by attending professional development courses, workshops, and training opportunities across a range of performing arts disciplines.

I actively seek opportunities to learn from other teachers, coaches, and industry professionals, valuing the wealth of knowledge and experience they have to offer. I am never afraid to ask questions, observe others, or step outside of my comfort zone, as I believe this is where the greatest growth happens.

By embracing new ideas, techniques, and teaching methods, I can continually evolve my own practice and bring fresh inspiration back into the studio. My commitment to lifelong learning ensures that my students receive high-quality, current, and engaging training, while also demonstrating the importance of curiosity, resilience, and a willingness to keep improving.

4. What impact have you had in the last year? *

Over the past year, the greatest impact I have made has been helping my students develop confidence, self-belief, and resilience. Watching children who once lacked confidence grow into performers who proudly step onto the stage, audition for leading roles, and believe in their own abilities has been incredibly rewarding.

I have worked hard to create a nurturing and inclusive environment where every student feels valued, supported, and encouraged to achieve their personal best. By celebrating progress, providing individual encouragement, and recognising that every child's journey is unique, I have helped students overcome fears, embrace challenges, and discover what they are truly capable of.

The impact extends far beyond the studio. Parents regularly share how their children have become more confident at school, formed stronger friendships, spoken up in class, and developed a greater sense of self-worth. Knowing that the confidence they build through performing arts positively influences every aspect of their lives is what makes teaching so meaningful to me.

For me, success isn't measured only by medals, exams, or performances—it's measured by the smile on a child's face when they realise they can achieve something they never thought possible.

5. Why should you be recognised now? *

Over the past four years, I have dedicated myself to building more than just a performing arts school—I have created a supportive, inspiring community where every child is encouraged to believe in themselves and reach their full potential.

Looking back on our journey, I am incredibly proud of how far we have come. From a small vision to a thriving school, I have had the privilege of watching so many students grow in confidence, develop lifelong friendships, achieve personal goals, gain examination success, perform on stage, and even progress towards professional training. Their achievements are a reflection of the positive, nurturing environment we have built together.

I believe now is the right time to be recognised because the impact of my teaching reaches far beyond dance and performing arts. My focus has always been on developing kind, resilient, hardworking young people who have the confidence to take on challenges both inside and outside the studio. Every child, whether they attend one class a week or train at an elite level, is celebrated and given the opportunity to shine.

This recognition would not only celebrate the work I have done over the last four years but also acknowledge the incredible journey of every student and family who has been part of All Stars. Seeing their growth, confidence, and success is the greatest achievement I could ever ask for, and it inspires me to continue making a positive difference for many years to come.

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